end of the 38th over, appearing poised to launch a real assault in the last dozen overs, to post a score in excess of 350 and effectively, we hope, take the game away from New Zealand.

What's that? Drizzle? I knew light showers had been forecast, but hoped they would come later in the day. The rain starts to fall harder, and the umpires decide we must leave the field. The break in play is frustrating, but we need to stay calm, to accept the weather and focus on controlling the controllables ...

We left the field at 4.50 pm, and play eventually resumed at 6.45 pm It was announced that the match would be reduced from 50 overs per side to 43 overs per side, and that the target New Zealand would be set to chase would be marginally greater than our score, supposedly taking into account the reality that we had batted for 38 overs, pacing ourselves as though we were going to bat for the full 50 overs.

It was complex and it was generally unsatisfactory because, in simple terms, we did not believe that the official calculations, following one or other contorted theory, would properly compensate us for the runs we would have scored in the extra seven overs we had expected to bat but were now denied.

However, there was no point moaning. Rules are rules and, just before 6.45 pm on what now was looking like a dry evening, Faf and I returned to the crease, preparing to face the last five overs of our innings. Faf got out off the second ball after the restart, unluckily gloving a leg-side wide to the wicketkeeper, and I was joined by David Miller, possibly the ideal batsman to launch an assault in the closing overs.

David delivered, striking four boundaries in the 40th over and taking a single off the last ball, and then hitting a boundary and two sixes in the 41st over. He continued to find the middle of the bat and was eventually out in the 43rd over, having scored what appeared to be 49 invaluable runs from only 18 balls, and there was still time for JP Duminy to hit a